



The Type 4 Hair Coaching Workbook

*Understand your hair, build your routine, and keep the length
you grow — a guided system for 4A, 4B & 4C.*

SCHICGIRL · A PERSONAL HAIR COACHING SYSTEM



YOUR COPY

This workbook belongs to

*Prepared with care for your Type 4 journey. Write your name above —
and make it yours.*

Started on _____ · Schicgirl

WELCOME



A note from SchicGirl

Why this workbook exists.

Dear friend,

If you've ever felt like your hair came *without a manual* — this is it.

Type 4 hair isn't difficult. It's just different, and most advice was never written for it.

So we built you a system: **test** what your hair actually needs, **build** a routine around it, and **track** what works — until length and health stop being luck.

You won't need a shelf of products. You'll need consistency and a plan you can trust. That's what's in your hands.

Take it one wash day at a time. Your future hair is already growing.

With love,

The SchicGirl team



YOUR TYPE 4 STUDIO

Diagnosis, routine, calendar & tracking - your interactive coaching app.

Scan the code or visit schicgirl.me/studio

How to use this workbook

Less reading. More knowing.

This isn't a book to read once and shelf. It's a coaching system. Move through the five parts in order — **test** your hair, **understand** what it's telling you, **build** a routine that fits, and **track** what works. Write in it. It becomes yours.

Five parts

- I · Know Your Hair
- II · Understand Your Needs
- III · Build Your Routine
- IV · Protect & Retain Length
- V · Track Your Progress

Every topic guides you

What it is → Quick Test → What it means → What to do →
What to avoid → Build your routine → Reflection.

Your guides along the way

✦ SCHICGIRL TIP

An insider shortcut that saves you time or money.

↑ QUICK WIN

One small action with a fast, visible result.

✕ COMMON MISTAKE

The trap most people fall into — so you don't.

◆ KEY TAKEAWAY

The one thing to remember from a topic.



Contents

Everything, at a glance.

Start Here	4
Part I · Know Your Hair	5
Part II · Understand Your Needs	9
Part III · Build Your Routine	12
Your Month at a Glance	14
Part IV · Protect & Retain Length	16
Style Lookbook	17
Part V · Track Your Progress	19
Read the Label	23
Glossary	24
Shrinkage, heat & from within	25
Your 90-Day Transformation	26
Photo & Length Log	27

This workbook offers educational guidance for everyday Type 4 hair care — not medical advice. For hair loss, scalp pain or skin conditions, please see a professional. Results vary with consistency.

QUICK START

Start Here

Your first 7 days.

You don't need to overhaul everything at once. Follow these seven days and you'll already have a routine that fits.

DAY 1 · MEET YOUR HAIR

- ☐ Do the porosity & elasticity quick tests
- ☐ Take a photo and measure your length (stretched)

DAY 2 · GET READY

- ☐ Pick your wash day
- ☐ Check your 5 product jobs (cleanse · detangle · leave-in · seal · style)

DAY 3 · FIRST WASH DAY

- ☐ Cleanse, deep condition, then moisturise (LOC / LCO)
- ☐ Style gently and seal your ends

DAYS 4–6 · KEEP IT SIMPLE

- ☐ Re-moisturise when hair feels dry; massage your scalp
- ☐ Satin at night · low manipulation

DAY 7 · REFLECT

- ☐ What felt good? Note it and plan next week

↑ QUICK WIN

Consistency beats perfection. A simple routine you actually repeat will always win.

PART I

Know Your Hair

*"You can't care for what you don't understand. This is
where it begins."*

Your Hair Profile · Porosity · Protein vs Moisture · Scalp Health



Your Hair Profile

Four answers that unlock everything else.

Type 4 isn't one thing. Pin down these traits once — they decide every product, wash and style choice from here on.



Your curl pattern

- 4A springy S-coils, holds moisture best.
- 4B sharp Z-bends, fluffy, less defined.
- 4C tightest zig-zag, up to 75%+ shrinkage.



Density & width

Density: ponytail under 2" = low · 2–3" = medium · 4"+ = high.
Width: roll a strand — barely felt = fine · felt = medium · thick = coarse.

✦ SCHICGIRL TIP

You can have more than one pattern on one head — that's normal. Style for your tightest area; it needs the most care.

My profile

Curl pattern

.....

Density

.....

Scalp type

.....

Porosity

.....

Strand width

.....

My #1 goal

.....

Porosity

How your hair drinks & holds water.

I WHAT IT IS

How easily your strands absorb and keep moisture — set by how tight or raised your cuticle sits. It quietly decides which products and water temperature actually work.

2 QUICK TEST

Drop a clean shed strand in a glass of water for 3–4 minutes. Where does it sit?

Floats

stays on top

Middle

sinks slowly

Sinks

drops fast

3 WHAT IT MEANS

Floats Low — tight cuticle, repels water, products sit on top.

Middle Medium — balanced & easy-going.

Sinks High — raised cuticle, drinks fast & loses fast.

4 WHAT TO DO

- ☐ Low → warm water, light water-based creams, clarify often, easy on protein.
- ☐ High → protein, richer butters (shea, castor), LCO method, cool rinse to seal.

× COMMON MISTAKE

Piling heavy butters on low-porosity hair — they sit on top as buildup, leaving hair greasy yet dry.

5 BUILD YOUR ROUTINE

My porosity is...

My sealing oil / butter

6 REFLECTION

When does my hair feel most moisturized — and what did I do differently?

Want to master moisture for good?

See **Hyratée** — the complete hydration system →

Protein vs Moisture

The balance that stops breakage.

1 WHAT IT IS

Healthy hair needs both: moisture for softness, protein for strength. Most "mystery" breakage is simply this balance tipped too far one way.

2 QUICK TEST

Gently stretch a single *wet* strand. What happens?

Snaps

breaks at once

Returns

stretches & bounces

Stays

limp / mushy

3 WHAT IT MEANS

Snaps Needs moisture — dry & brittle.

Returns Balanced — keep your rhythm.

Stays Needs protein — over-moisturized & weak.

4 WHAT TO DO

☐ Needs moisture → deep-moisture mask, LOC, hydrating leave-in.

☐ Needs protein → a light protein or rice-water treatment, then re-balance with moisture.

× COMMON MISTAKE

Chasing "more moisture" when hair is actually protein-starved — it stays mushy and keeps snapping no matter how much you hydrate.

↑ QUICK WIN

One rice-water rinse can revive limp, over-moisturized curls in a single wash. Use sparingly — once a month.

5 BUILD YOUR ROUTINE

Right now my hair feels...

This week I'll add...

6 REFLECTION

After my last protein treatment, did my hair feel stronger or stiffer?

Scalp Health

The soil your growth comes from.

I WHAT IT IS

Every strand grows from the scalp. A clean, stimulated, balanced scalp matters more than any growth oil in a bottle.

2 QUICK TEST

One day after washing, with no product on, my scalp feels...

Tight

dry / flaky

Normal

comfortable

Oily

greasy / itchy

3 WHAT IT MEANS

Tight Dry — gentle hydration, soothe, don't over-wash.

Normal Balanced — maintain & massage.

Oily Cleanse a little more often; check for buildup.

4 WHAT TO DO

☐ Cleanse regularly · massage 5 min/day · exfoliate monthly · soothe itch with tea-tree.

✕ COMMON MISTAKE

Greasing the scalp to "moisturize" it — heavy oils clog follicles and cause buildup and itch, not growth.

◆ KEY TAKEAWAY

A clean, stimulated scalp beats any growth oil. And styling should never hurt — pain or bumps mean it's too tight (traction alopecia).

5 BUILD YOUR ROUTINE

My scalp type is...

My weekly scalp ritual...

Struggling with flakes or an itchy scalp?

See Adieu Pellicules — the scalp recovery guide →

PART II

Understand Your Needs

*"Stop guessing. Your hair is always telling you what it
needs."*

Hair Goals · The Decision Tree · Products & Ingredients

Hair Goals

Decide where you're going.

A routine without a goal is just maintenance. Choose what matters most this season — your plan will bend toward it.

TICK YOUR GOALS

- ☐ Retain length & reduce breakage
- ☐ More moisture & softness
- ☐ A healthier, calmer scalp
- ☐ More curl definition
- ☐ Master protective styling
- ☐ Grow back my edges

◆ KEY TAKEAWAY

For Type 4, growth is rarely the problem — **retention** is. Most goals come back to the same thing: keep the length you already grow.

MAKE IT REAL

My #1 goal this season is...

.....

It matters to me because...

.....

One habit I'll commit to...

.....

The Decision Tree

"What should I do next?"

When you're unsure, start here. Find the line that matches your hair today, and do what it points to.

Dry, rough & snapping? → **Moisture.** Deep-condition, then LOC. Lower your wash temp.

Limp, mushy, won't hold a curl? → **Protein.** A light protein / rice-water treatment, then re-balance.

Itchy, flaky or sore scalp? → **Scalp care.** Cleanse, exfoliate, soothe. See Part I.

Breaking, single-strand knots? → **Handling.** Gentle detangling, satin nights, dust the ends.

Weighed down, dull, won't absorb? → **Clarify.** A clarifying wash to lift buildup, then deep-condition.

Just tired of doing your hair? → **Protect.** A low-manipulation protective style for 2–4 weeks.

♦ **SCHICGIRL TIP**

When two things feel true at once, treat the scalp and moisture first — strength comes easier once those are handled.

Products & Ingredients

Buy less. Choose better.

You don't need forty products — you need the right five jobs covered for your porosity.

THE JOB	WHAT IT DOES	LOOK FOR
Humectant	Pulls water in	Glycerin, honey, aloe
Protein	Strengthens & fills gaps	Hydrolysed keratin/silk, rice water
Emollient	Softens & smooths	Oils, fatty alcohols (cetyl)
Sealant	Locks moisture in	Shea, castor, jojoba
Cleanser	Cleans gently	Sulfate-free surfactants

✕ GO EASY ON

Drying alcohols (alcohol denat), harsh sulfates if you're dry, non-soluble silicones & mineral oil (buildup), heavy waxes.

✦ SCHICGIRL TIP

Match weight to porosity: low porosity loves light & water-based; high porosity loves rich creams & butters. Introduce one product at a time so you know what works.

BUILD YOUR SHELF

My cleanser

My leave-in

My cream / butter

My sealing oil

PART III

Build Your Routine

"Consistency beats intensity. Simple, done often, changes everything."

Routine Builder · Wash Day · Your Month · Seasons & Climate

Routine Builder

Turn your profile into a plan.

Pull your answers from Part I into one simple weekly rhythm. This is your routine — written by you, for your hair.

WHAT	YOUR PLAN (FROM YOUR PROFILE)
Wash	
Moisturize (LOC / LCO)	
Protein	
Scalp ritual	
Trim / dust ends	
Nightly	

♦ STARTING POINT

4A → wash ~weekly. 4B/4C or very dry → every 7–14 days. Low porosity → LOC + warm water. High porosity → LCO + cool rinse + protein more often. Adjust from there.

↑ QUICK WIN

Protect every night with satin and re-moisturize your ends — this one habit saves more length than any product.

Wash Day

In the right order, every time.

How you handle wet hair decides how much length you keep. Tick each step — slow and gentle always wins.

- ☐ 1 · **Pre-poo** — oil & finger-detangle to protect before washing.
- ☐ 2 · **Cleanse** — focus the scalp; gentle / sulfate-free.
- ☐ 3 · **Deep condition** — 20–30 min with heat; detangle here.
- ☐ 4 · **Leave-in** — on soaking-wet hair.
- ☐ 5 · **Seal** — cream + oil (LOC / LCO).
- ☐ 6 · **Style & protect** — then satin bonnet at night.

✕ COMMON MISTAKE

Detangling dry, or rubbing with a terry towel. Detangle with slip on damp hair; blot with a microfiber towel or t-shirt.

◆ KEY TAKEAWAY

Style on **soaking-wet** hair. It's the single biggest upgrade to definition and moisture for Type 4.

Your Month at a Glance

Wash days highlighted.

Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
1 Wash	2 Moist	3 Scalp	4 Moist	5 Refresh	6 Protect	7 Rest
8 Protein	9 Moist	10 Scalp	11 Moist	12 Refresh	13 Protect	14 Rest
15 Mask	16 Moist	17 Scalp	18 Moist	19 Refresh	20 Protect	21 Rest
22 Clarify	23 Moist	24 Scalp	25 Moist	26 Trim	27 Protect	28 Rest

LEGEND — WHAT EACH ICON MEANS

 Wash day (cleanse + deep condition)

 Moisture mask

 Moisturize (LOC / LCO)

 Refresh curls (light spritz)

 Rest (low manipulation)

 Protein wash

 Clarify (lift buildup)

 Scalp massage

 Protective style

 Trim check (dust ends)

★ RHYTHM

Week 1 wash + deep condition · Week 2 + protein · Week 3 + moisture mask · Week 4 + clarify & trim check. Repeat.

Seasons & Climate

Adjust to your weather — wherever you live.

Temperate seasons



Winter

Heaviest butters · low-manipulation · add protein.



Spring

Fresh trim · clarify · restart scalp work.



Summer

UV & salt protect · lighter hydration · braids.



Autumn

Strengthen · rebuild moisture · assess shedding.

Africa & the tropics



Dry season & Harmattan

Hair at its driest: heaviest butters, seal twice, shield from dust, mist daily.



Rainy & humid

Anti-frizz cool rinse · dry fully (mildew risk) · protective styles hold well.



Strong sun & heat

Headwraps for UV · extra hydration · rinse scalp after sweat.



Hard water

Clarify / chelate often · final rinse with filtered or bottled water.

◆ KEY TAKEAWAY

Harmattan and dry season are your hair's hardest test — lean fully into butters, sealing and protective styles.

PART IV

Protect & Retain Length

"Type 4 hair grows. The art is helping it stay."

Detangling · Style Lookbook · Troubleshooting

Detangling & Handling

Where most length is lost — or saved.

THE GENTLE METHOD

- ☐ Only on damp hair with slip (conditioner) — never dry coils
- ☐ Work in 4–6 sections; clip the rest away
- ☐ Start at the ends, move up to the roots
- ☐ Fingers first, then a wide-tooth comb
- ☐ Patience over speed — don't rip through knots

× COMMON MISTAKE

Detangling root-to-tip. You drag every knot down into a bigger one. Always ends-first.

↑ QUICK WIN

Single-strand knots? Stretch your styles (twist-outs, braid-outs) instead of wearing it loose — less tangling, less breakage.

REFLECTION

When do I see the most shed/broken hair — and what was I doing?

.....

Style Lookbook

Ideas to try — tick your favourites.



Quick & everyday

Wash-and-go · high puff · mini puffs · headwrap · low bun



Defined out-styles

Twist-out · braid-out · bantu knot-out · finger coils



Dressed up

Twisted updo · bantu knots · halo braid · accessorised puff

✦ SCHICGIRL TIP

Always moisturise before styling, never install too tight, and keep heat occasional. Out-styles on wash day; protective styles for low-manipulation weeks.



Troubleshooting

Problem · cause · fix.

PROBLEM	LIKELY CAUSE	FIX
Constant dryness	Porosity mismatch, hard water	LOC/LCO, deep condition, chelate
Breakage	Protein/moisture imbalance	Re-balance, gentle handling, trim
Single-strand knots	Loose wear, dry ends	Stretch styles, moisturise ends, dust
Frizz	High porosity, humidity	Cool rinse to seal, hands off
Length stalls	Breakage, not growth	Protect, satin, trim, moisture
Thinning edges	Tension styles	Loosen, massage; see a derm if it spreads
Itchy / flaky scalp	Dryness, buildup	Cleanse, exfoliate, soothe

Flakes that won't quit?

See [Adieu Pellicules](#) — the scalp recovery guide →

PART V

Track Your Progress

*"What gets written down gets better. This is where it
shows."*

30-Day Reset · Wash-Day Log · Length Tracker · Monthly Review

30-Day Reset

One small action a day. Tick as you go.

1 Clarify + reset	2 Elasticity test	3 Deep condition	4 LOC ends	5 Scalp massage	6 Protective style
7 Satin rest	8 Moisture mist	9 Hot oil scalp	10 Finger-detangle	11 Wash + DC	12 Squish to condish
13 Moisturize + seal	14 Edge care	15 No-heat day	16 Rice water	17 Moisture mask	18 Scalp exfoliate
19 Refresh style	20 Greenhouse	21 Wash + clarify	22 Photo + length	23 LOC moisturize	24 Self-care
25 Flaxseed gel	26 Massage + oil	27 Deep condition	28 Dust ends	29 Product review	30 Plan + celebrate

♦ HOW TO USE IT

Follow in order or pick the day that fits — consistency beats perfection. Repeat any time your hair needs a reset.



Wash-Day Log

Learn what your hair loves.

DATE	PRODUCTS USED	DEEP CONDITIONER	STYLE	HOW IT FELT



12-Month Length Tracker

Measure stretched hair from the same spots.

MONTH	FRONT	CROWN	NAPE	NOTES
Jan				
Feb				
Mar				
Apr				
May				
Jun				
Jul				
Aug				
Sep				
Oct				
Nov				
Dec				

◆ KEY TAKEAWAY

Expect $\sim\frac{1}{2}$ " a month. Growing but not gaining length? The issue is retention, not growth — revisit moisture, trims & night protection.



Monthly Review

Print one a month. Keep them together.

THIS MONTH MY HAIR FELT...

WHAT WORKED (PRODUCTS, STYLES, HABITS)

WHAT I'LL CHANGE NEXT MONTH



WIN OF THE MONTH

Read the Label

Insider knowledge for the ingredient list.



Moisture & humectants

Glycerin · aloe · panthenol · honey · marshmallow root



Seal & soften

Shea & mango butter · jojoba · castor · avocado oil



Strength (protein)

Hydrolysed wheat / silk / keratin · rice protein



Gentle cleansers

Coco-/decyl-glucoside · "sulphate-free"

✗ GO EASY ON

Drying alcohols (alcohol denat., SD alcohol) · harsh sulphates (SLS) · heavy mineral oil/petrolatum on its own · too much protein if your porosity is low.

Your shopping checklist

- ☐ Sulphate-free cleanser
- ☐ Deep conditioner
- ☐ Leave-in
- ☐ Oil or butter
- ☐ Protein treatment

- ☐ Gel / custard
- ☐ Satin bonnet or scarf
- ☐ Wide-tooth comb
- ☐ Spray bottle
- ☐ Hair clips

✦ SCHICGIRL TIP

Ingredients are listed by amount — the first five tell you what a product really is.

Glossary

The words, demystified.

Pre-poo

An oil/conditioner before washing to protect & ease detangling.

Co-wash

Washing with conditioner only — gentle, between full washes.

Clarify

A deeper wash that strips product buildup.

Chelate

Removes hard-water mineral buildup.

LOC / LCO

Layering order: Liquid—Oil—Cream to lock moisture in.

Leave-in

A conditioner you don't rinse out — your moisture base.

Slip

How slippery a product makes hair, so it detangles safely.

Deep condition

A rich 20–30 min treatment, ideally with heat.

Seal

Locking water in with an oil or butter on top.

Dusting

Trimming the very tips to remove splits without losing length.

Shrinkage

How much Type 4 hair coils up when wet — a sign of health.

Pineapple

Gathering hair high on the head to protect curls overnight.

Greenhouse method

Covering damp hair to trap warmth & moisture.

Single-strand knot

A tiny knot on one strand — common in 4C; dust to manage.

Squish to condish

Scrunching water + conditioner in for maximum moisture.

Humectant

An ingredient that pulls water into hair (glycerin, aloe).

Hydrolysed protein

Small proteins that fill gaps in the strand to strengthen.

Low manipulation

Touching/restyling as little as possible to keep length.

Shrinkage, heat & from within

Understand it, stretch it, feed it.

◆ SHRINKAGE IS HEALTH

Up to 75%+ shrinkage is a sign of elasticity & health — not a problem. It's normal for Type 4.

STRETCH WITHOUT HEAT

- ☐ Banding (soft ties) or African threading
- ☐ Twist-outs & braid-outs
- ☐ Curlformers or roller sets

× HEAT, WITH CARE

Always use a heat protectant · keep flat irons under ~365°F / 185°C · occasional, never routine. Heat damage = curls that go limp and never revert.



From within

Protein, iron, biotin, vitamins D & C, omega-3, water. Sleep & stress matter too.



Dose it right

Start with less than you think. Apply section by section on soaking-wet hair, and add more only where it's still dry.

Example — a filled-in routine (4C, high porosity)

WHAT	THE PLAN
Wash	every 7–14 days
Moisturize	LCO — shea butter
Protein	every 2–3 weeks
Scalp	massage 5 min/day
Trim	dust every 8–12 weeks
Nightly	satin bonnet + seal ends

Your 90-Day Transformation

Small steps, compounded.

DAY 1 • SET YOUR BASELINE

Take photos, measure your length, choose your routine.

DAY 30 • BUILD THE HABIT

Wash days on rhythm, scalp calm, less breakage on wash day.

DAY 60 • SEE THE SHIFT

Better moisture retention, styles last longer, fewer single-strand knots.

DAY 90 • KEEP YOUR LENGTH

A routine that runs itself — compare your photos.

✦ SCHICGIRL TIP

Photograph in the same spot, same light, hair stretched. The comparison is what keeps you going.



TRACK

Photo & Length Log

Proof you can see.

DATE	LENGTH (STRETCHED)	STYLE	HOW IT FEELS

◆ SCHICGIRL TIP

Measure from the same section each month. Note your hair mood too — it counts.



CONGRATULATIONS

Certificate of Completion

This certifies that

has completed the SchicGirl Type 4 · 90-Day Hair Journey —
with consistency, care, and intention.

Date

SchicGirl · Hair Coaching



Your hair, on a plan.

Consistency beats intensity. Do the simple things often — hydrate, seal, protect, balance, be gentle — and your length will follow.

Go deeper

- 💧 Hydratée — hydration system
- 🌱 Pousse — growth method
- ✨ Adieu Pellicules — scalp recovery

A note

General educational guidance, not medical advice. For hair loss or a painful scalp, see a dermatologist or trichologist. Patch-test new products.

SCHICGIRL · CLARITY, CARE & CONFIDENCE